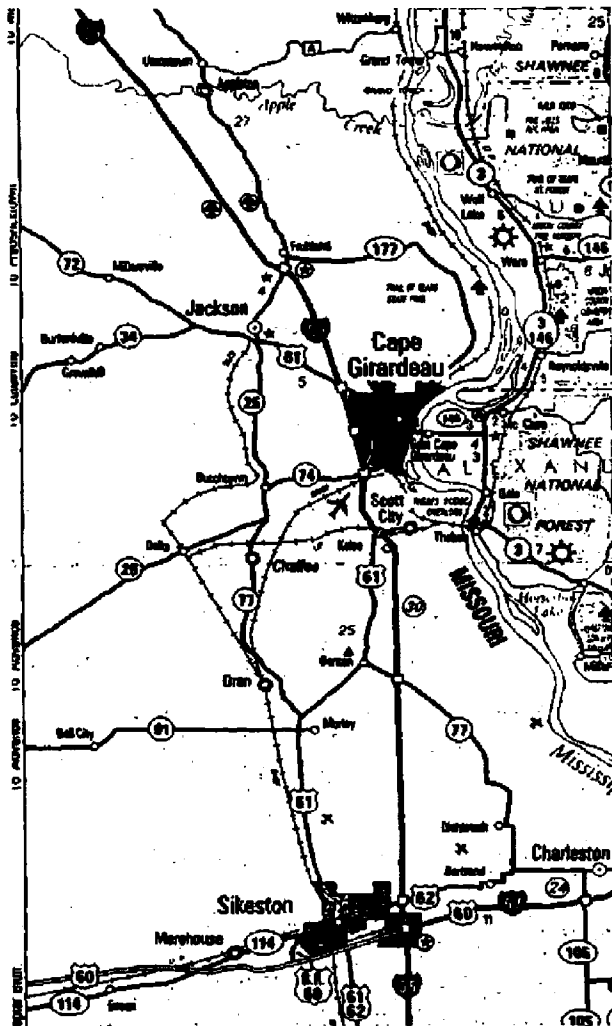


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Charlette Mann



Rev. William Huffman

UFO crash in Cape Girardeau,
Missouri in 1941?

An ongoing investigation

Did a UFO crash in Missouri in 1941?

By Ryan S. Wood

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This case was first publicized when Len Stringfield, in his book *UFO Crash/Retrievals: The Inner Sanctum, Status Report VI*, shared an astounding letter from Charlette Mann, the granddaughter of Reverend William Huffman. Charlette told of the deathbed account by her grandmother, who during the course of several days described an unusual event that Rev. Huffman attended late one early spring night just 10-15 miles outside of Cape Girardeau, MO.

Huffman was a traveling Baptist minister who had moved to Cape Girardeau and started ministering at the Red Star Baptist church in early 1941, according to church records. The quick summary of the event was that when Huffman arrived at the scene, there were police, fire, FBI, and photographers already there, and he was asked to provide blessings to the three dead occupants of an unusual craft.

During this process he observed the command mod-

ule with hieroglyphic writing inside, and prayed over each of these non-human entities. When the military arrived, everyone was sworn to secrecy, yet upon returning home to 1530 Main Street he chose to share this story with his wife and family.

With this intriguing story and later personally meeting

Editor's Note

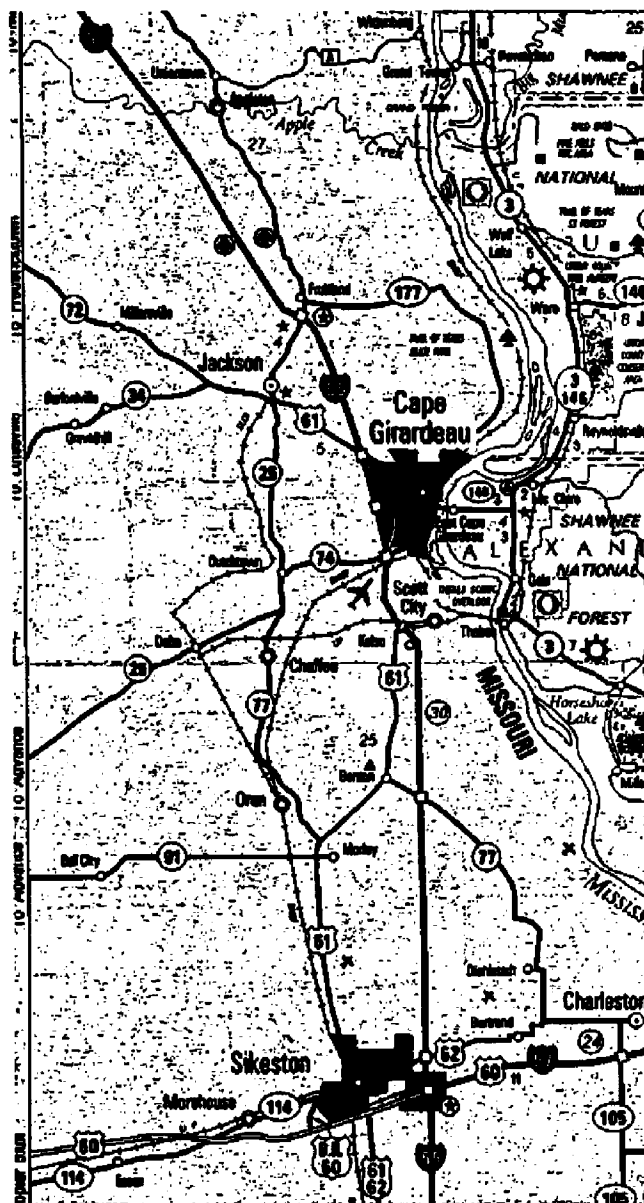
As author Ryan Wood acknowledges, the 1941 crash of a UFO in the Cape Girardeau area is only a tantalizing possibility, not a proven fact, and the investigation is far from complete. Thus far, all of the evidence is based on second-hand testimony and controversial documents.

There is a formerly secret government document which indicates that, six years after the alleged incident, a top Air Force officer was unaware of any crashed UFOs. This is the Sept. 23, 1947, letter from Lt. Gen. Nathan Twining, head of the USAF Air Materiel Command, to Brig. Gen. George Schuigen, an Air Force intelligence officer. However, there is some evidence that even high-ranking military officers may not have had access to information regarding crash recoveries, and government utilization of faked documents for cover-up and misinformation is also possible.

At least one individual close to government research and development, Dr. Robert Sarbacher, has suggested that such crashes and recoveries have occurred.

In looking at the total picture, there appears to be enough evidence to justify continued research on possible UFO crashes, including Cape Girardeau.

As additional information becomes available, it will be shared with *Journal* readers. A more detailed account of Wood's investigation is included in the 2001 *MUFON Symposium Proceedings*.



Charlette, I became convinced that here was a credible witness and bizarre story that was in dire need of validation. That confirmation came from many sources in the past few years, with the freshly revealed Majestic documents from Tim Cooper and others that clearly point to a UFO crash retrieval in Missouri in 1941. Central to this case is the testimony of Charlette Mann, declassified documents that suggest pre-Roswell events, and witness interviews that vary in credibility and scope—but all sources have provided valuable data for the reality of this historic event. More exotic investigation tools, such as remote viewers or intuitive experts, have provided additional research avenues that are being investigated.

The primary witnesses

Rev. Huffman had a unique specialty in the Baptist church: he had the gift of raising money. He was a specialist who spent about four years in a specific location to build a church, attendance, fellowship, and cash flow. He would connect with local leaders to improve the exposure and participation at the church. He was also a horticulturist, and, despite the stern look in his picture, had a good deal of charm and innate salesmanship.

Upon returning from his escorted trip to the crash site, he proceeded to tell his wife and sons what had just happened in the woods a short drive outside of town. It was this retelling of the events that odd night in 1941 to his wife Floy that Charlette would hear in 1984 from her grandmother over the course of several days as Mrs. Huffman was dying of cancer.

It is important to note that this is not the only time Charlette was exposed to this story. During her childhood she heard bits and pieces of the story from conversations between her father and uncle, and when Floy was dying, Charlette pressed her to fill in the specific details as to what really happened that spring evening in 1941.

It took a fair amount of pleading with her grandmother initially to convince her to violate the commitment she had made to her husband not to speak of it. Eventually, Charlette succeeded in extracting the story. She kept after the story for several days, clarifying with her grandmother until Charlette was confident that she completely understood what had happened and the de-

tails. Here is part of the story in Charlette's own words as recorded for Wood & Wood LLC's upcoming television documentary "The Secret: Evidence We Are Not Alone."

"She (Floy) said that grandfather was called out in the spring of 1941 in the evening around 9:00-9:30, that someone had been called out to a plane crash outside of town, and would he be willing to go to minister to people there, which he did. Upon arrival it was a very different situation. It was not a conventional aircraft, as we know it.

He described it as a saucer that was metallic in color, no seams, did not look like anything he had seen. "It had been broken open in one portion," says Charlette, "and so he could walk up and see that. In looking in, he saw a small metal chair, gauges and dials, and things he had never seen. However, what impressed him most was around the inside there were inscriptions and writings, which he said he did not recognize, but were similar to Egyptian hieroglyphics.



Rev. William Huffman

"There were three entities, or non-human people, lying on the ground. Two were just outside the saucer, and a third one was further out. His understanding was that perhaps that third one was not dead on impact. There had been mention of a ball of fire, yet there was fire around the crash site, but none of the entities had been burned and so father did pray over them, giving them last rites.

"There were many people there, fire people, photographers, and so they lifted up one, and two men on either side stood him up and they stretched his arms out, they had him up under the armpits and out here. As I recall from the picture I saw, he was about 4 feet tall, appeared to have no bone structure, soft looking.

"He had a suit on," explains Charlette, "or we assume it was a suit; it could have been his skin, and it looked like crinkled, soft aluminum foil. I recall it had very long hands, very long fingers, and I think there were three, but I cannot swear to that."

Other living supporting witnesses include Charlette Mann's sister, who confirms her story in a notarized sworn affidavit, and the living brother of the Cape Girardeau County sheriff in 1941, Clarence R. Schade. These witnesses and the others who were there, should have been there, or likely would have known about this crash event will be examined later.

Now let us turn our attention to other key validating

About the author

Ryan Wood earned the Bachelor of Science in mathematics and computer science from California Polytechnic State University in 1978. A director of business development and sales for an energy conservation company, Wood has been active in researching documents related to UFOs, and manages the www.majesticdocuments.com web site. He has completed with Dr. Robert M. Wood a TV documentary entitled "The Secret," along with publishing two books and a CD ROM dealing with the Majestic Documents. He is a MUFON investigator, an Eagle Scout, a Black Belt in Goju-Ryu, and a triathlete.

sources for this crash recovery event in 1941—the military intelligence documents.

The document trail

Are there public, authentic documents that support and corroborate the hypothesis of before-Roswell crash retrieval events? The first public evidence of this is the February 1942 "LA Air Raid." In this case, for a couple of hours a slow moving craft was illuminated with spotlights, 1430 rounds of ammunition were fired, many clear direct hits, according to witnesses of the disk shaped object. George C. Marshall (GCM) then writes a secret memo to the President about this event.

However, what is fascinating is that this memo sets up the authentication of a leaked top secret memo that tells a different story of crash recoveries. Yet the most stunning evidence for pre-Roswell events comes from leaked military and presidential intelligence documents. Seven leaked documents from three sources since 1994 provide both direct and indirect support for a crash retrieval event that Rev. Huffman recounts.

It is clear from the first memo that President Franklin D. Roosevelt writes to Marshall on Feb. 27, 1942: "I have considered the disposition of the material in possession of the Army that may be of great significance toward the development of a super weapon of War... Consultation with Dr. Bush and other scientists on the issue of finding practical uses for the atomic secrets learned from study of celestial devices..."

Just days after the L.A. air raid and related saucer crash retrievals it would be impossible for the President to have "considered the disposition" of the material collected at that L.A. event; therefore, he must be referring to an earlier crash. Which brings us to that ever-nagging question: so how do we know that these fantastic statements and documents are authentic?

Are the documents authentic?

The key evidence for authenticity are format and language, with liabilities primarily the document origin. Although not discussed here, the logic for faking such documents is extremely weak and is discussed in another paper on Psychological Warfare and the Majestic Documents that can be found on our website.

However, another document that is even more supportive of the pre-Roswell hypothesis and that has fewer liabilities is the Top Secret memo from Marshall to the President dated just one week after the Los Angeles air raid on March 5, 1942. It discusses the creation of the a special unit ultimately to become the Interplanetary Phenomena Unit (IPU) and the crash retrievals of two more saucers: one by the Army in the San Bernardino Mountains, east of Los Angeles, and

the other salvaged by the Navy off the southern California coast, presumably because of anti-aircraft fire.

Again the questions must turn to why is this document authentic? What impresses me besides the visual appearance of the document, showing a clear carbon smudge, available at www.majesticdocuments.com, is the fact that just two weeks later Marshall's offices switched from the Office of Chief of Staff (OCS) filing system and memo numbering to the war department system. So, besides the proper Marshall word usage and format, it has the correct filing numbers that link it to the Los Angeles air raid. The downside is that it is not original paper.

Next we come to a memo addressed to the Non-Terrestrial Science and Technology Committee, on White House stationary dated February 22, 1944, which is stamped Double Top Secret and signed by FDR. This memo says that before we can exploit these "super weapons of war" we need to win the war. It goes on to say that when we have won the war the USA must assume its destiny; there will be a time when surplus funds will be available; and finally, FDR commends the committee for its work. This documents authenticity is supported by the rare Double Top Secret stamp and unique language.

The 1941 recovery case

In the MAJIC Eyes Only presidential briefing dated September 24, 1947. (Mission Assessment of Recovered Lenticular Aerodyne Objects – White Hot Intelligence Estimate) two sections directly cite the 1941 recovery case.

The first is in "Part III — Scientific Probabilities," and the second in "Part V — National Security Structure." Part III states: "Based on all available evidence collected from the recovered exhibits currently under study by AMC, AFSWP, NEPA, AEC, ONR, NACA, JRDB, RAND, USAAF SAG and MIT, are deemed extraterrestrial in nature. This conclusion was reached as a result of comparisons of artifacts from the Missouri discovery in 1941. The technology is outside the scope of US Science, even that of German rocket and aircraft development."

The "from the Missouri" logically fits into the space provided and is consistent with supporting testimony, although I'm sure that other words would fit and make sense. The fact that in Part V the author laments the lack of a unified intelligence effort I think is noteworthy and a valid point for authenticity. It is just another subtlety that is hard to create out of whole cloth and insert seamlessly.

Here is what was said: "In the early months of 1942, up until present, intrusions of unidentified aircraft have occasionally been documented, but there has



Charlette Mann

been no serious investigations by the intelligence arm of the Government. Even the recovery case of 1941 did not create a unified intelligence effort to exploit possible technological gains, with the exception of the Manhattan Project."

Besides the unique period language, what moved it to the 95% confidence level for authenticity was my research into the personnel on the mission. During the process of tabulating President Truman's White House switchboard traffic for who called whom, when, and how often, I came across the name of Captain Charles Buchanan. He was the only captain ever mentioned in the 1947 phone records and—wouldn't you know it—General Carter calls Captain Buchanan on July 7, 1947 at 4:44 PM. So, is this just a coincidence? I don't think so.

Who was at the crash site?

To answer this question fairly takes considerable time; there are the direct comments of Huffman, and then the logical extensions that flow from the Huffman statements. A more complete discussion is in this year's *MUFON International Proceedings*. Here is what Charlette said about who was at the crash site:

"My grandfather, upon arrival, said there were already several people there on the scene, two that he assumed were local photographers, fire people. And so not long after they arrived, the military just showed up, surrounded the area, took them off in groups separately, and spoke to each of them. Grandfather didn't know what was said to the others, but he was told 'this didn't happen; you didn't see this; this is national security; it is never to be talked about again.'

"My grandfather was an honorable man, being a preacher; that's all that needed to be said to him. And so he came home and told the story to my dad, who was there, and my grandmother and my uncle. Now my mother was expecting at the time, so she was off in the bedroom. My sister was born May 3rd 1941, so we are assuming this was the middle to the last of April. And he never spoke of it again.

"But about two weeks later, one of the men who had a personal camera that he had put in his shirt pocket approached Grandfather and said, 'I think someone needs a copy of this. I have one and I would like you to keep one.' So that's how it came about that Grandfather had the picture to begin with. But he never spoke of it again. The other people seem to be very intimidated and very frightened and paranoid."

This photo was later in the possession of Charlette's father, Guy Huffman, who reportedly allowed a photographer friend to borrow it in the 1953-55 time



Author Ryan Wood and Marcel Kujisten, webmaster at National Archives, who is assisting in researching this case.

frame, and the photo was never returned. The photographer's name was Walter Wayne Fisk. Stan Friedman, also recognizing the importance of this picture, tracked Fisk down in New Mexico and spoke with him on the telephone, where a strange tale emerged.

Fisk stated he had a doctorate in psychology, yet Friedman was unable to verify his claim, along with Fisk's statement that he was an advisor to presidents. Fisk has repeatedly refused to answer or respond to phone calls or letters written by Charlette Mann.

Since this event happened outside of the town limits, the county sheriff, Ruben Reinhold Schade, would have been the responsible party. Ruben's brother Clarence provided a supportive, but not definitive, statement when interviewed: "Yes, I heard of a space ship with 'little people' back a long time ago, but never believed it."

Although nowhere near as powerful as the Huffman-Mann testimony, I give it partial credit for being a sincere recollection, especially given the wording he used, "little people" rather than ET, alien or non-human.

It is logical to believe that if this event is real, that many others would have heard about it over the years or in secretive conversations or wild tales. Each of these persons and family members are being researched.

When and where did it crash?

When may be easier than where, but as of this writing solid progress has been made on both questions. We know from Charlette's testimony that Huffman was driven about 10-15 miles outside of town, and then had to walk about one-fourth of a mile or so off the road into an open field where a fire was burning. Given these basic parameters the search area has narrowed to about five square miles, actually areas adjacent to roads at the time. Historical aerial photography is available for October 1941 and provides a complete stereoscopic overflight of the area. Many areas look promising, and resolution is just a matter of execution.

Charlette's testimony is that the crash happened one

April 1941 evening, because her mother was pregnant with her sister who was born on May 3rd of 1941. The fire department records for Cape Girardeau are very precise. Although there is no clear stunning match with Charlette's story, there are several good candidates. According to the story, the fire department was on site, but which one, Jackson or Cape or both? If they were sworn to secrecy by the military, would they write the event down in their logbook, or would they record it accurately?

At present, all I have is the Cape fire logbook for 1941. An examination of fires in the evening for late March and April show only a few possible matches. On March 30, from 6:22 p.m. to 6:58 p.m. in Houck Woods (actually Louis Houck who lived in the correct area—10-15 miles out of town). On April 22, from 11:59 p.m. to 4:35 a.m. at the Blattner brothers residence out highway 61, again the right area.

It will take a review of the historical aerial photography to verify these fires. At this time the precise location and date are unconfirmed; further research with police, military records, and fire call logs is planned, along with aerial photography and ground surveys.

Although of speculative value without confirmation, Joe McMoneagle (Intuitive Intelligence Applications) provided data purporting that there are small pieces of wreckage still at the crash site that are recoverable. Annette Martin, another well-known psychic sleuth, confirmed much of the Huffman-Mann story and provided new checkable data.

Is this real?

After working on this case for about two years and talking with Charlette Mann on numerous occasions, either briefly on the phone, over dinner, or in front of a television camera, her story, demeanor, and integrity have provided no hints of deception or confabulation. I, like Leonard Stringfield ten years earlier, came to the conclusion that here was a very sincere woman with a quality case worthy of a dedicated effort at validation.

The story does not hinge on Charlette's testimony alone; there are the low level stories from credible people like Clarence Schade that loosely support the event. Then there is the deliberate silence of Wayne Fisk, the last person to have handled the alien picture. Adding more weight to the truth side is the highly believable and likely authentic military and presidential documents that support a crash retrieval in 1941.

It is the totality of these facts that leads me to think it is reasonable to conclude that there was a crash event as described by Rev. Huffman's wife to Charlette Mann.

The final resolution to this case is still out there. It may come in the form of physical evidence, bits of wreckage, new witnesses, historical aerial photography, soil samples, or archival research. All these fronts are being actively worked, and there is every reason to predict success. Anyone having additional information on witnesses, stories, documents, leads, personnel records, and historical records is requested to contact me.

Keel's *Mothman Prophecies* scheduled for movie theaters

"The Mothman Prophecies," a film based on the 1975 book by ufologist John Keel, is to be released Feb. 22, 2002. "Primal Fear" co-stars Richard Gere and Laura Linney will reunite for this film.

It is described as "a cerebral and creepy tale of the paranormal," and is supposedly based on actual events that transpired in Point Pleasant, WV, between November 1966 and December 1967. The time frame of the original occurrences has been condensed and updated, and the story now happens over the course of a few weeks during the present. The names of the main characters, some of whom are based on actual people, have also been changed.

The protagonist is *Washington Post* political reporter John Klein (Gere), an up-and-coming journalist who interacts with influential people on Capitol Hill and is being eyed for a job at CNN. He has a beautiful wife named Mary, and life seems to be going his way, but things begin to fall apart.

He discovers the drawing of a bug-like man that Mary has drawn. A year later, while traveling in West Virginia, his car breaks down and he has a bizarre encounter with a rural homeowner who claims John has come to his door at exactly the same time three nights in a row. Even worse, he discovers he has somehow traveled four hundred miles out of his way in less time than was possible.

He soon learns of all the other odd goings-on that have been happening lately in Point Pleasant. It seems a number of locals, including many "normal" and well regarded folks, have seen strange lights over the Ohio River while others have had visions of a strange bug or bird-like man. A drawing of this creature rocks John when he realizes this is the exact same image Mary drew. And bizarre events continue, as in the book.

Fate Magazine taken over by Phyllis Galde

Lakeville, MN—Llewellyn Worldwide, Ltd. of St Paul, MN has reached a licensing agreement with Phyllis Galde, owner of Galde Press, Inc., for the right to publish *Fate Magazine*. Galde has been Editor-in-Chief of *Fate* since December of 1999.

Llewellyn granted the trademark license after it had considered discontinuing the magazine in August Galde inherits all responsibilities for publishing the longrunning magazine which was launched in 1947 by Curtis Fuller and Ray Palmer.

Carl Weschcke had this to say about the move, "When the Fullers decided to retire in 1988, they sold *Fate* to Llewellyn, and we did our best to carry on with their intent. Today, however, it is time to pass the torch yet again. *Fate* is an adventure into this greater and wonderful world: Phyllis Galde is your guide."